

How n8n Uses Docker Hardened Images to Secure Critical Links in Its Software Supply Chain

February 2026

Before we start...



The session is being recorded and will be shared



Use Q&A feature to ask questions



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Your speakers



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n8n

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02. n8n's "fair source" strategy

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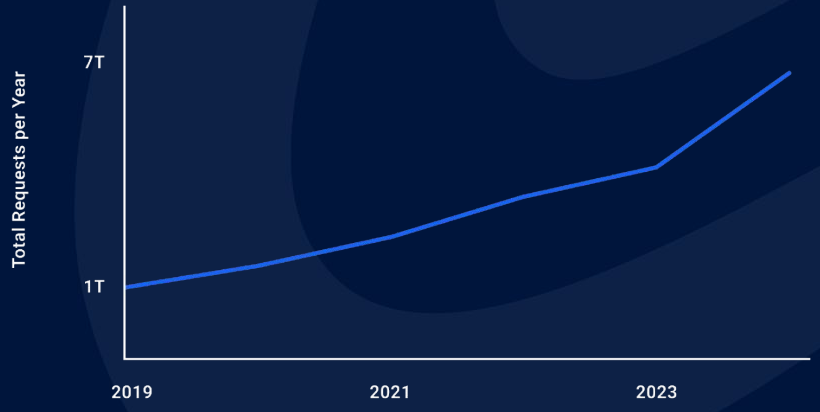
04. Who can use Docker Hardened Images

05. Wrap up and Q&A



Container adoption and CVEs are both growing exponentially

Open-source downloads across major ecosystems



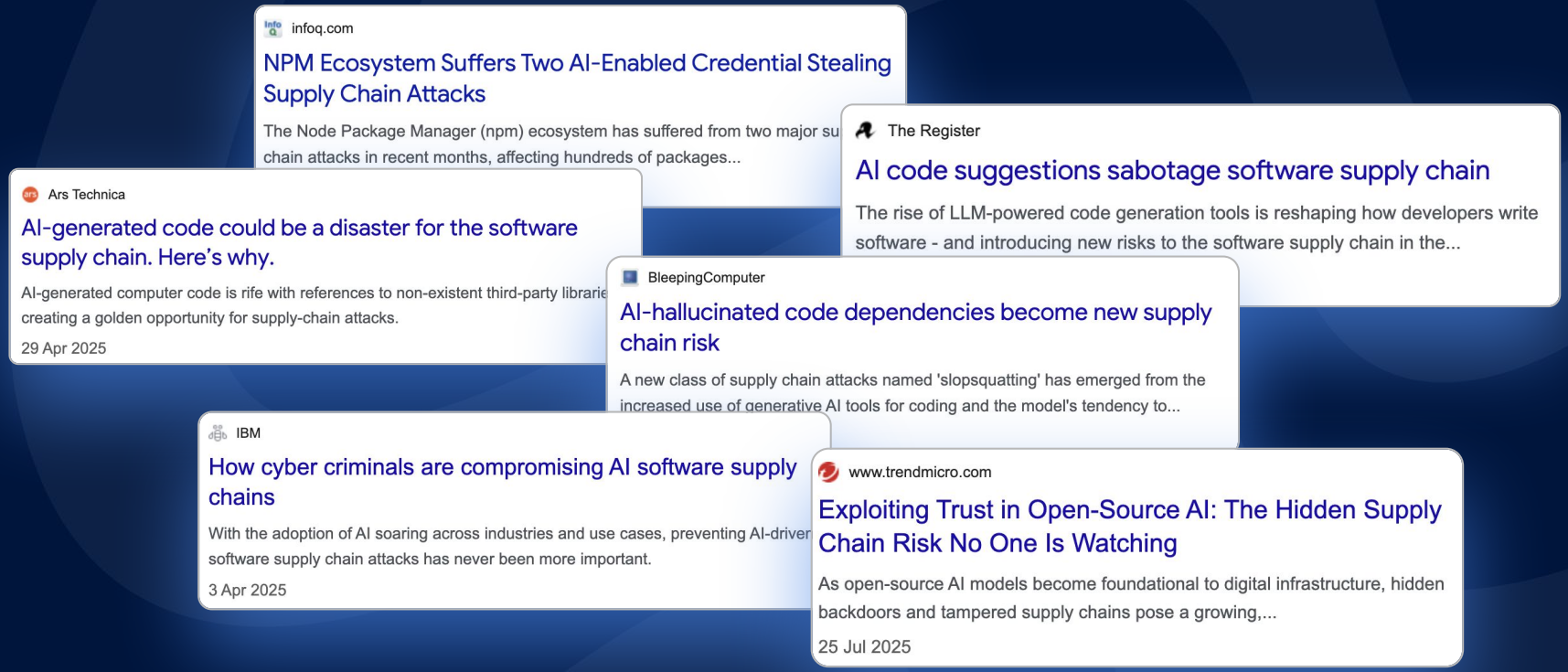
Source: Sonatype
www.sonatype.com/state-of-the-software-supply-chain/introduction

Total Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures (CVEs)



Source: National Vulnerability Database
788960_C

The stakes are higher with autonomous decisions driven by AI



Expecting every team to manage CVEs, rebuild images, validate fixes... across every dimension

To do

- Customization pipeline
- Compliance
- Release engineering
- Test and validation
- Security engineering
- Build and provenance
- Platform engineering
- Upstream lifecycles

× times

Image Types

Every base OS image
Every runtime (Python, Node, etc.)
Every application image
Every variant (debian, alpine, dev, prod)
Every architecture (amd64, arm64)

× times

Versions & Lifecycles

Every major version
Every minor and patch version
Every supported upstream lifecycle
Every EOL transition
Every backported fix

× times

Security events

Every new CVE
Every severity change
Every exploit disclosure
Every dependency vulnerability

× times

Compliance & Policy

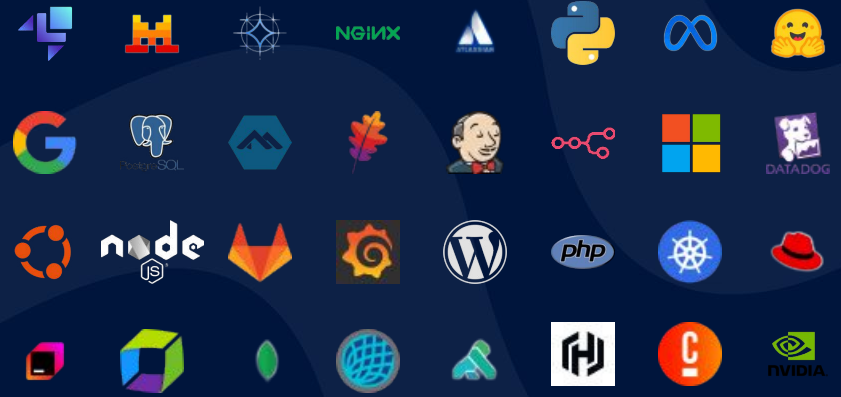
Every compliance standard (FIPS, STIG)
Every regulated environment
Every customer customization

This is very hard to do at scale

Docker Hub: the backbone of open source delivery

11B+

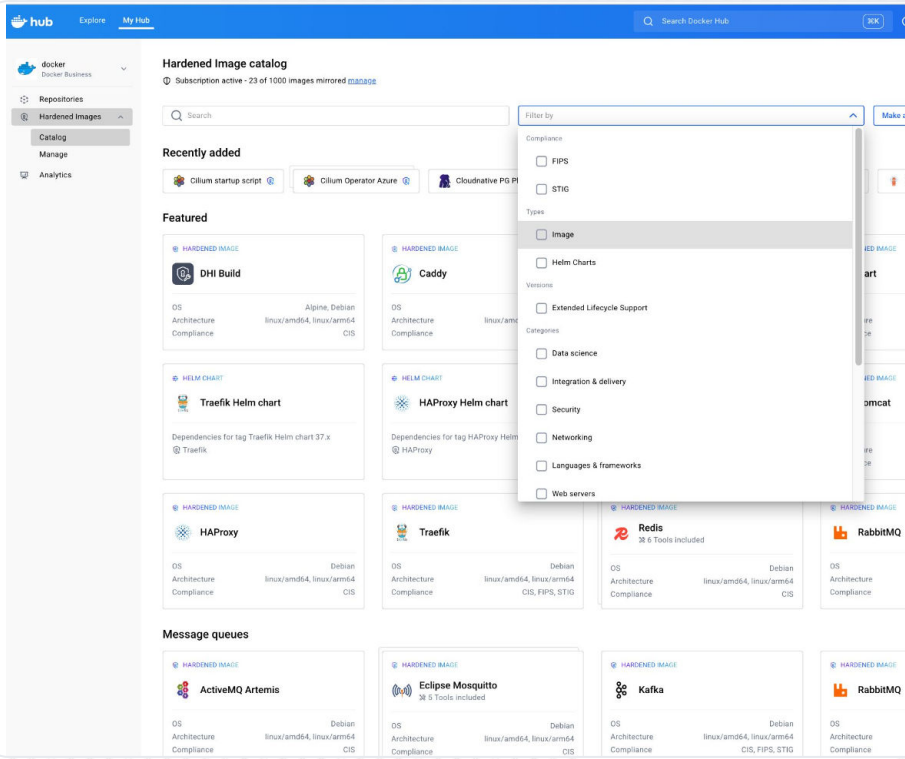
monthly image downloads



14M+ images

Docker Hardened Images - FREE to use for every developer

- Fully open source under Apache 2.0
- 1000+ hardened, minimal images with near-zero CVEs
- Verifiable SBOMs and SLSA Build Level 3 provenance
- Multi-distro compatibility



n8n



Migration and Impact



Docker discussion

Discussion

- PR switching n8n base image to docker hardened image
  - Example PR about security issues reported before DHI usage
  - PR dhi issue with legacy docker runtimes due to ZSTD compression support
- Task Runners and our distroless image compared to DHI images

Who can use DHI today

Anyone can use DHI whether you're an individual dev, a startup or an enterprise. Here's what you need to know:

If you're an individual developer, open-source maintainer...

DHI

- ➔ Secure, transparent, and no-cost for everyone
- ➔ Hardened, minimal images
- ➔ Verifiable SBOMs & SLSA Level 3 provenance
- ➔ Open source under Apache 2.0

If you're working at an enterprise

DHI Enterprise

Everything in DHI, plus operational and security enhancements

- ➔ Contractual SLA; critical CVE fixes <7 days
- ➔ FIPs/STIG variants
- ➔ Image Lifecycle Management with Customizations
- ➔ Built on Docker's Secure Build System

Q&A



Get in touch with us

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Join the Docker Community

Join the n8n Community



Thank you